

HR Policies

Document Information

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Vacation Policy

Entitlement

Full-time employees are entitled to **20 paid vacation days** per calendar year. Vacation days accrue at a rate of 1.67 days per month of employment.

Part-time employees receive vacation days on a pro-rated basis according to their contracted hours.

Requesting Vacation

- Employees must submit vacation requests through the **HR Portal** (portal.apextech.solutions/leave)
- Requests should be submitted **at least two weeks in advance** for optimal approval
- Rush requests (less than 48 hours notice) require director-level approval
- Managers will review requests based on:
 - Team workload and coverage
 - Project deadlines and milestones
 - Existing approved leave requests
 - Business critical periods (e.g., product launches, quarter-end)

Blackout Periods

The following periods have limited leave availability due to business needs:

- Last two weeks of each fiscal quarter (March 15-31, June 15-30, Sept 15-30, Dec 15-31)
- Major product release windows (communicated 60 days in advance)

Carryover Rules

- Unused vacation days can be carried over to the next calendar year
- **Maximum carryover:** 10 days
- Days beyond this limit expire on **March 31** of the following year
- Employees will receive notification in December if they have excess days at risk

Special Circumstances

- **New Hires:** Receive prorated vacation based on start date
- **Departing Employees:** Unused vacation is paid out upon termination (up to 30 days maximum)
- **Extended Leave:** For sabbaticals or unpaid leave exceeding 30 days, vacation accrual is suspended

Example Scenario:

Sarah joins ApexTech on March 15, 2026. By year-end, she will have accrued approximately 13.6 vacation days (8.33 months × 1.67 days). She can use these days or carry up to 10 into 2027.

Sick Leave Policy

Entitlement

All full-time employees receive **10 paid sick days** per calendar year, accruing at 0.83 days per month.

Eligible Uses

Sick leave may be used for:

- Personal illness or injury
- Medical, dental, or mental health appointments
- Caring for an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling)
- Preventive care and wellness visits
- Recovery from medical procedures

Notification Requirements

- **Same-day illness:** Notify your manager via Slack or email before 9:30 AM
- **Planned medical appointments:** Request through HR Portal with 48 hours notice when possible
- **Extended absence:** Contact HR (hr@apextech.solutions) if absent more than 2 consecutive days

Medical Certification

A medical certificate may be required if:

- Absent for more than **3 consecutive days**
- There is a pattern of frequent Monday/Friday absences
- Returning from medical leave or surgery

Certificates should be submitted to hr-confidential@apextech.solutions within 5 business days of return.

Unused Sick Leave

- Sick days do **not carry over** to the next year
- Unused sick leave is **not paid out** upon termination
- Employees with perfect attendance may be eligible for quarterly wellness bonuses (see Benefits Overview)

Working Hours

Standard Schedule

The standard working hours at ApexTech Solutions are:

- **Core Hours:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM
- **Days:** Monday – Friday
- **Weekly Hours:** 40 hours

Lunch Break: Employees are entitled to a 1-hour unpaid lunch break, typically between 12:00 PM - 2:00 PM.

Flexible Work Arrangements

Employees may request flexible schedules subject to manager approval. Options include:

- **Flex Start Times:** Begin between 7:00 AM - 10:00 AM
- **Compressed Workweek:** Four 10-hour days (requires VP approval)
- **Hybrid Schedule:** See Remote Work Policy

Approval Criteria:

- Role compatibility (customer-facing roles may have constraints)
- Team coverage requirements
- Performance track record
- Equipment and security compliance

Time Tracking

- **Exempt employees:** Not required to track hours, expected to fulfill job responsibilities
- **Non-exempt employees:** Must clock in/out via Workday system
- **Overtime:** Non-exempt employees receive 1.5× pay for hours beyond 40/week (requires pre-approval)

Attendance Expectations

- Punctuality is expected; repeated tardiness may result in disciplinary action
- Unexcused absences are taken seriously and documented
- 3+ unexcused absences in a 90-day period may lead to performance review

Public Holidays

ApexTech Solutions observes the following paid holidays:

- New Year's Day
- Martin Luther King Jr. Day
- Presidents' Day
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving Day + Day After
- Christmas Eve (half day)
- Christmas Day
- 2 Floating Holidays (employee choice, subject to approval)

Full holiday calendar available in Company Wiki

Code of Conduct

Core Principles

ApexTech Solutions is committed to maintaining a respectful, inclusive, and ethical workplace where all employees can thrive.

Expected Behavior

All employees must:

- Treat colleagues, customers, and partners with respect and professionalism
- Communicate honestly and transparently
- Protect confidential company and customer information
- Avoid conflicts of interest
- Comply with all applicable laws and regulations
- Report unethical behavior or policy violations

Prohibited Behavior

The following behaviors are strictly prohibited and may result in immediate termination:

Harassment & Discrimination

- Any form of harassment based on race, gender, age, religion, disability, sexual orientation, or other protected characteristics
- Unwelcome sexual advances, comments, or conduct
- Bullying, intimidation, or retaliation

Unethical Conduct

- Fraud, theft, or embezzlement
- Falsification of records or timesheets
- Accepting bribes or kickbacks
- Insider trading or misuse of confidential information

Workplace Disruption

- Violence or threats of violence
- Possession of weapons on company property
- Working under the influence of drugs or alcohol
- Willful damage to company property

Social Media & External Communications

- Employees are personally responsible for their social media content
- Do not disclose confidential company information online
- When discussing ApexTech publicly, clarify that views are your own
- Respect copyright and intellectual property laws

Reporting Violations

If you witness or experience a code of conduct violation:

1. **Immediate Safety Concerns:** Contact Security (ext. 9111) or 911
2. **Manager/HR Report:** Contact your manager or HR Business Partner

3. **Anonymous Hotline:** 1-800-APEX-ETH (ethics hotline, available 24/7)

4. **Email:** ethics@apextech.solutions

Non-Retaliation Policy: ApexTech prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports violations in good faith.

Investigation Process

- All reports are taken seriously and investigated promptly
- Confidentiality is maintained to the extent possible
- Investigations typically conclude within 15 business days
- Appropriate corrective action will be taken if violations are substantiated

Disciplinary Actions

Violations may result in:

- Verbal or written warning
- Performance improvement plan
- Suspension (with or without pay)
- Demotion or reassignment
- Termination of employment

The specific action depends on the severity and frequency of violations.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I use vacation days in my first month of employment?

A: Vacation days accrue monthly, so you can use accrued days once they're available (approximately 1.67 days after your first full month). Some managers allow early access for urgent needs; discuss with your manager and HR.

Q: What happens to my vacation days if I'm promoted or change departments?

A: Your vacation balance transfers with you. Accrual rates remain the same unless you move from part-time to full-time status (or vice versa).

Q: Can I donate sick days to a coworker in need?

A: Yes, ApexTech has a Sick Leave Sharing Program. Contact HR for details and forms.

Q: What if I need to leave early for a family emergency?

A: Notify your manager immediately. Emergency situations are handled with flexibility. You can use sick leave, vacation, or unpaid time depending on the circumstance.

Q: Are summer Fridays offered?

A: Yes! From June 1 - August 31, employees may leave at 3:00 PM on Fridays with manager approval, provided work is complete.

Q: How do I report a code of conduct violation anonymously?

A: Call the 24/7 ethics hotline at 1-800-APEX-ETH or submit via the online form at apextech.ethicspoint.com

Q: Can I work remotely while traveling?

A: "Workcations" require advance approval. See Remote Work Policy for guidelines on working from different locations, tax implications, and international travel restrictions.

Related Documents

- Employee Handbook - Company mission, values, and culture
- Benefits Overview - Comprehensive benefits package details
- Remote Work Policy - Work-from-home guidelines
- Onboarding Guide - New employee setup
- Security Policy - Data protection and password requirements

Questions or Clarifications?

Contact Human Resources:

- Email: hr@apextech.solutions
- Phone: ext. 2100
- Office: Building A, 2nd Floor
- HR Portal: portal.apextech.solutions
- Office Hours: Monday-Friday, 8:30 AM - 5:30 PM